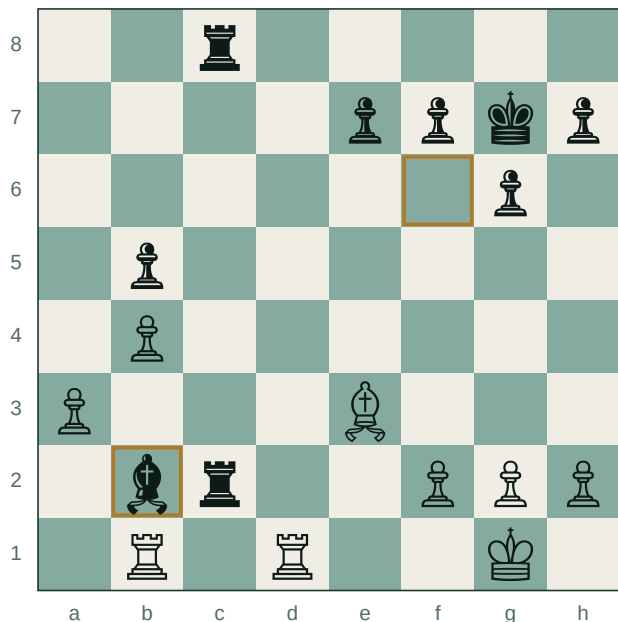


Forks and double attacks: White, move 23

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 22...Bb2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Rxb2 Rxb2 24. Bd4+ f6 25. Bxb2

23.Rxb2 The rook captures the bishop on b2. Recorded reply: **23...Rxb2**.

24.Bd4+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From d4 it attacks king on g7 and rook on b2. Recorded reply: **24...f6**.

25.Bxb2 The bishop captures the rook on b2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.